PRIVATE
Unlisted briefing for One1000. It is not part of damienmulhall.com, isn't linked from the site and is hidden from search engines. Please don't share it outside One1000. This page will be deleted on Tuesday 3 November 2026, so download a copy if you want to keep it.

BRIEFING FOR ONE1000 · 27 OCTOBER 2026

Dell Sales Chat: what we actually know

What Dell's in-house AI tool for sellers is, what it can and can't do, and what it might mean for our work. Public sources only.

WHAT	USERS	BUILT BY	LIVE SINCE
Internal AI assistant for Dell sellers	About 20,000 sellers	Dell, in-house	Sept 2025 at the latest

How to read this

CONFIRMED Dell said it on the record, or a credible outlet reported it, and we read the source ourselves.

UNVERIFIED We've only seen it second-hand. Check it before repeating it.

OUR VIEW Our own inference. Treat it as opinion.

The short version

01

Sales Chat is real, and it's now how Dell sellers find information.

It's Dell's own internal AI assistant, rolled out to all of its roughly 20,000 sellers. Dell switched off the older seller tools when it launched. **CONFIRMED**

02

It reuses content Dell already has. It doesn't create anything new.

Dell describes it as pulling content together from across its systems. Sellers use it to find information, summarise it, draft content and automate emails. CONFIRMED

03

Nothing in public says it has replaced agency work.

That we've seen work drop off is our observation, not something we can prove from outside. OUR VIEW

04

The next wave is aimed at partners.

Dell's new partner platform, launching in the second half of 2026, is run by "a family of AI assistants". CONFIRMED That puts channel marketing in the frame next. OUR VIEW

05

Lean into what a chat tool can't do, and widen the client base.

In the short to medium term, pitch and run more cutting-edge AI events for Dell and NVIDIA, such as hackathons and hands-on labs, plus complex, expert-led content like e-guides. In the longer term, win clients beyond Dell. OUR VIEW

The numbers, with caveats

20,000

Dell sellers using it

Roese, Dell CTO. Approximate.

3 to 13

Hours a week Dell says it saves each seller

Dell's blog says 3 to 5, TIME says 13. Self-reported, no method given.

69%

Of B2B buyers prefer to check AI insights with a rep

Gartner, May 2026. Not Dell-specific.

11,000

Fewer Dell staff in a year

Dell 10-K, Mar 2026. Marketing isn't singled out.

What is confirmed

Dell built Sales Chat for its sellers, "rolled it out to all of our sellers and turned off all the other systems". Sellers use it to "access information, distill it, create content, even automate emails."

John Roese, Dell Global CTO and Chief AI Officer. ARN, 1 Sep 2025

It is "the only system that must remain online" for Dell's sales teams. The systems feeding it "can temporarily fail".

Roese. DQ India, Dec 2025

It saves sellers "three to five hours a week" by "curating content from across a distributed data estate".

Dell blog, 11 Mar 2026

Dell's CFO calls it "our own internal sales chat CRM model", which has "handed back multiple hours per week" to sellers.

Fortune, 30 Mar 2026

Sales is one of the few areas Dell picked for AI under its "Customer Zero" programme, alongside supply chain, services and engineering. Dell cut about 800 AI ideas down to a handful.

Fortune, 22 Jan 2025; SiliconANGLE, 12 May 2026

Dell's new partner platform is an "agentic partner experience" (AI that takes actions, not just answers questions), "powered by a family of AI assistants". It covers demand signals, deal registration and real-time pricing, and rolls out in the second half of 2026.

Dell Technologies World, 18 May 2026. Channel Buzz; Futurum

Dell's headcount is about 97,000, down roughly 11,000 in a year. The stated reasons are reorganisation and limits on external hiring.

Dell FY2026 10-K, Mar 2026

Dell's CMO calls becoming AI-native "existential" and says buyers now start their journeys with AI tools.

SiliconANGLE, 28 May 2026

What we can't confirm yet

Claimed, but unverified UNVERIFIED

- The hours-saved figures don't agree: 3 to 5 a week on Dell's blog, 13 in TIME (Sep 2026), which doesn't name the tool. Treat both as Dell's own claims.
- Roese reportedly said Dell had to clean up its sales data before launch, and that the tool searches Dell's documents by meaning. Podcast page blocked; search summary only.
- Dell's 2025 analyst meeting reportedly called it "the most modern sales tool we've ever given our sales force". Transcript blocked; search summary only.

Not known

- Which vendor or AI models it runs on. Dell uses Glean internally, but nobody links Glean to Sales Chat.
- Exactly what content it pulls from, and who at Dell owns that content.
- Whether it handles pricing, specs, proposals or other languages.
- Whether partners will get it or something like it.
- Its launch date.

Where it's strong, and where it isn't

Good at

01

- Finding and summarising existing content
- First drafts
- Call prep and cutting admin

Falls short

02

- Repeats stale or wrong source content confidently
- Tone, idiom and local relevance in other languages
- Buyer trust: most buyers still want a person to check

Can't do

03

- Live events and roundtables
- Filmed video with real people
- Sign-off across several companies
- New research or customer proof

OUR VIEW Based on independent research into AI sales tools in general (Gartner, May 2026; Appen; an ACL 2026 benchmark where the best model scored 2.1 out of 3 on cultural adaptation), not on Sales Chat specifically.

Fair objections

Is Sales Chat really what's eating our work?

We can't prove it from public sources. What we can say is that Dell has deliberately made one AI tool the place sellers go for content, and it lets them draft their own. Routine enablement copy is the work most likely to be affected. It's worth checking our own job history against when Sales Chat launched.

Isn't this just AI hype?

Some of it is. Dell's hours-saved numbers are self-reported and contradict each other. But the structural facts don't depend on those numbers: the tool is live, it's mandatory, and the old tools are gone.

Dell will just do it all in-house.

Possibly, and the headcount cuts point that way. But there's no public sign of an agency review. Dell's CMO also says Dell uses partners to fill gaps in its internal readiness. The risk is real, but it hasn't happened.

We don't know enough to act.

Agreed, which is why the first step below is about finding out, not committing.

Next steps

- **Find out who owns Sales Chat's source content.** Ask our Dell contacts which team runs it, what content it pulls from, and whether any One1000-made content is in there. That tells us if our work is feeding the tool or being bypassed by it.
- **Check our own job history.** Have battlecards, one-pagers, talk tracks or seller emails dropped off since mid-2025? That shows how big the problem actually is.
- **Then commit to the plan below.** The first two steps tell us how hard to push on each part.

The plan OUR VIEW

Short to medium term: own the cutting-edge AI events

- Pitch and run hackathons, hands-on AI labs and expert-led sessions. That's where Dell and NVIDIA most want their customers' attention right now.
- Build on the Dell x NVIDIA lab we're already running in EMEA, and bring in the specialists these formats need.
- Much of this content currently comes out of Dell's San Francisco offices, with a few events in London. Running more of it here, and running it well, is the opening.
- Every event produces the digital content around it: films, recaps, follow-up kits. That's our moat, and Sales Chat can't host a room.
- Pitch more complex content that AI can't produce in one go, such as e-guides. AI can already draft long copy. What it can't do is the work around it: interviewing experts, shaping the argument, design, legal and product sign-off, and adapting it for each market. Sell that, not word count, and the work stays defensible for the next few years as the models improve.

Longer term: de-risk by winning clients beyond Dell

- Relying on one client is a bigger risk than any single tool. Sales Chat just makes it visible.
- The AI-event track record above is exactly what other tech brands will want to see, so the two halves of the plan feed each other.

Supporting options, if the first steps point that way

01

Keep Sales Chat's source content in shape

We write and maintain the approved content the tool draws on, retire stale assets, and report gaps based on what sellers ask. This works with the tool rather than against it.

02

Check AI output for brand and legal compliance

We already do brand and legal compliance work for Dell. Forrester predicts a Fortune 500 firm will sue a B2B supplier over AI-generated misrepresentation in 2026.

03

Prepare for the partner platform

Templates, tone guidance and approval rules for content the partner AI assembles.

Worth repricing over time: routine one-pagers, battlecard refreshes, straight translation and hours-based production. Procurement teams across the industry now expect AI savings on this kind of work (Digiday, 8 Aug 2025).

Sources

ARN, Roese on Customer Zero, 1 Sep 2025

DQ India, Roese's 2026 predictions, Dec 2025

Dell blog, 11 Mar 2026

Fortune, Dell CFO, 30 Mar 2026

Fortune, Roese on AI ROI, 22 Jan 2025

TIME, Roese, 22 Sep 2026

SiliconANGLE, Dell Technologies World, 12 May 2026

SiliconANGLE, Dell CMO on AI-native, 28 May 2026

Channel Buzz, partner platform, May 2026

Futurum, partner programme

Dell FY2026 10-K

Gartner, buyers and AI, 20 May 2026

Digital Commerce 360, Forrester predictions, 28 Oct 2025

Digiday, agency pricing, 8 Aug 2025

ACL 2026, cultural adaptation benchmark

Dell blog, Glean, 19 May 2025